

Using the TUI

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md2tex

md2tex includes a Textual-based TUI so you can convert Markdown to TeX without memorizing CLI flags.

1. Install TUI dependency

```
1 pip install ".[tui]"
2 # or
3 uv sync --extra tui
```

2. Launch the TUI

```
1 md2tex tui
2 # or
3 md2tex interactive
```

3. Fill the form

- Input Markdown File (*.md) [required]: path to your source .md file.
- Output TeX File (*.tex) [optional]: custom output path. If empty, default output path is used.
- Template File (*.tex) [optional]: custom template for complete TeX generation.
- document_class: choose article or book.
- Complete TeX file (-c): wraps output with preamble/template.
- Unnumbered headers (-u): uses unnumbered section commands.
- French quotes (-f): converts inline quotes using \{\}\{\}enquote{\}.
- Compile PDF: runs pdflatex twice after conversion.
- Enable shell-escape: enables -shell-escape in compilation and allows minted backend in auto mode.

Press **Convert** to run the selected workflow.

4. Understand the result logs

The log panel reports each step explicitly:

- Successful TeX generation: shows exact `.tex` path.
- Successful PDF compilation: shows exact `.pdf` path.
- Temporary LaTeX artifacts are removed automatically (`.aux`, `.log`, `.out`, `.toc`, `.synctex.gz`, `_minted-*`).
- Compilation failure: shows a compact error summary with next action.

5. Code block backend behavior

`md2tex` now uses backend strategy `auto` by default:

- With shell-escape enabled: uses `minted` for fenced code blocks with language.
- Without shell-escape: falls back to `listings` to avoid minted compile failures.

This prevents the common error:

Package minted Error: You must invoke LaTeX with the `-shell-escape` flag.

6. Step-by-step example

1. Run `md2tex tui`.
2. Set Input Markdown File to `docs/tui.md`.
3. Enable Complete TeX file (`-c`).
4. Enable Compile PDF.
5. If you need minted syntax highlighting, enable `Enable shell-escape`.
6. Click `Convert`.
7. Check log lines for generated `.tex` and `.pdf` paths.

7. Troubleshooting

- `pdflatex` is not installed or not in `PATH`: install TeX Live/MacTeX and retry.
- `minted` requires `-shell-escape`: enable `Enable shell-escape`, or run without it so backend `auto` uses `listings`.
- Input path error: ensure the input file exists and has `.md` extension.
- Template token error: custom template must contain `@@BODYTOKEN@@`.